SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "SAINT-ESTÈPHE"

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Saint-Estèphe", initially recognised by the decree of 14 November 1936.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No specific provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Saint-Estèphe" is reserved for still red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area:

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the commune of Saint-Estèphe, in the Gironde department.

2° – Delimited parcel area:

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 8 September 1994.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of the commune of Saint-Estèphe the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area:

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing, is made up of the territory of the following communes of the Gironde department: Cissac-Médoc, Pauillac, Saint-Sauveur, Saint-Seurin-de-Cadourne and Vertheuil.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties:

The wines come from the following varieties: cabernet franc N, cabernet-sauvignon N, carmenère N, cot N (or malbec), merlot N and petit verdot N.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding:

No specific provision.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods:

a) – Planting density.
The vines present a minimum planting density of 7,000 plants per hectare.

These vines may not present a spacing between rows greater than 1.50 metre and a spacing between plants within the same row of less than 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.
Pruning is carried out at the latest by the spread-leaves stage (Lorenz stage 9).

The vines are pruned according to the following techniques with a maximum of 12 free eyes (buds) per plant:

- the so-called “médocaine” cane pruning, or spur-and-cane pruning, the plant bearing two canes of at most 4 eyes per cane for the varieties cot N, cabernet-sauvignon N, merlot N and petit verdot N, or 5 eyes at most per cane for the varieties cabernet franc N and carmenère N. The return spurs are pruned to two free eyes;

- spur pruning to 2 cordons, or four-arm fan training.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.
The height of the trellised foliage must be at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows for vines whose spacing is less than 1.40 metre.

The height of the trellised foliage must be at least equal to 0.7 times the spacing between rows for vines whose spacing is between 1.40 metre and 1.50 metre inclusive. However, this height may be at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows for vines meeting the specific provisions concerning the limit yield.

The height of trellised foliage is measured from 0.10 metre below the bending wire up to the upper topping limit.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 9,500 kilograms per hectare. This load corresponds to a maximum number of:

- 14 bunches per plant for the petit verdot N variety and for pruning carried out as cordon and fan;

- 12 bunches per plant for the other varieties.

Where irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 644-23 of the Rural Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 8,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 644-22 of the Rural Code is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels must be managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices:

Before each new planting, every operator must carry out a physico-chemical analysis of the soil of the parcel in order to have all the information necessary to know the viticultural situation and its potential.

3° – Irrigation:

Irrigation during the vine's growing period may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 644-23 of the Rural Code.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest:

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions. No specific provision.

c) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest. No specific provision.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes:

a) Grapes with a sugar content of less than 189 grams per litre of must for merlot and 180 grams per litre of must for the other varieties may not be considered to be at proper ripeness.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 11 %.

c) – Minimum actual alcoholic strength by volume. No specific provision.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield:

The yield referred to in Article D. 644-25 of the Rural Code is fixed at 57 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield:

a) – The limit yield referred to in Article D. 644-25 of the Rural Code is fixed at 63 hectolitres per hectare.

b) – For vines whose spacing is between 1.40 metre and 1.50 metre inclusive and whose trellised foliage height is between 0.6 and 0.7 times the spacing between rows, the limit yield is fixed at 60 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines:

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the second year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the first year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the first year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the designation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the designation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions:

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Reception and pressing. No specific provision.

b) – Blending of the varieties. No specific provision.

c) – Malolactic fermentation. Every lot of wine marketed presents a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.30 gram per litre.

d) – Analytical standards. Every lot of wine marketed presents a content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to 2 grams per litre.

Every lot of wine marketed in bulk presents a volatile acidity content less than or equal to 13.26 milliequivalents per litre, i.e. 0.79 gram per litre expressed as acetic acid (0.65 gram per litre expressed as H2SO4) until 31 July of the year following that of the harvest, and less than or equal to 16.33 milliequivalents per litre, i.e. 0.98 gram per litre expressed as acetic acid (0.80 gram per litre expressed as H2SO4) after that date.

e) – Oenological practices and physical treatments. Subtractive enrichment techniques (SET) are authorised within the limit of a maximum concentration rate of 15 %.

After enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13.5 %.

f) – Overall vat capacity. Every operator must have a vinification vat capacity at least equal to 1.5 times the average ten-year claimed production of the holding.

The vinification capacity available at the time of harvest corresponds to the vinification containers such as the vinification vats and the barrels.

g) – Good overall condition of upkeep of the cellar (floor and walls) and of the equipment (hygiene). The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product:

The wines undergo ageing at least until 1 June of the year following the harvest and at the latest until 31 December of the third year following that of the harvest.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging:

a) – Packaging is carried out at the earliest on 1 June of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the defence and management body and for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 644-36 of the Rural Code;

- an analysis carried out before or after packaging.

The analysis reports must be kept for a period of six months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage:

The operator demonstrates a specific place protected (rain, wind…) for the storage of the packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer:

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer. At the end of the ageing period, the wines may be placed on the market for the consumer only from 1 September of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers. The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on 1 March of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

[No text in this version of the specification.]

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Delimited parcel area:

The parcels planted with vines excluded from the parcel production area, identified by their cadastral references and their area, continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin “Saint-Estèphe” until their grubbing-up and at the latest until the 2020 harvest included, subject to meeting the other provisions of the present specification.

The list of the parcels concerned is attached in annex 1.

2° – Training method:

a) Parcels of vines in place at 31 July 2009 and presenting a planting density of less than 6,500 plants per hectare continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin

until grubbing-up and at the latest in 2035, subject to compliance with the trellising and foliage-height rules laid down in the present specification.

b) Parcels of vines in place at 31 July 2009 and presenting a planting density between 6,500 plants per hectare and 7,000 plants per hectare continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until their grubbing-up.

c) The provision relating to the spacing between rows does not apply to vines in place at 31 July 2009.

d) From the 2016 harvest, for parcels of vines in place at 31 July 2009 and not having a minimum trellised foliage height at least equal to 0.7 times the spacing between rows, the limit yield is fixed at 60 hectolitres per hectare.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions:

No specific provision.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1° – Claim declaration:

The claim declaration must be sent to the defence and management body before 31 December of the year of the harvest.

It indicates:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied by:

- a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts;

- and the cellar plan (place of vinification and storage), allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

2° – Fallback (repli) declaration:

Every operator marketing a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin under a more general appellation must declare it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of one month after this fallback.

3° – Prior declaration of removals and packaging:

Operators wishing to make a bulk shipment, a rendu-mise or a partial bottling must complete a transaction declaration and transmit it to the approved control body and to the defence and management body within fifteen working days before the scheduled date of the organoleptic examination.

Operators wishing to have the whole of their cellar controlled, with a view to bottling, must complete a packaging declaration and lodge it with the approved control body and the defence and management body within fifteen working days before the scheduled date of the organoleptic examination.

4° – Downgrading declaration:

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must declare it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of one month after this downgrading.

5° – Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine:

Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must declare it to the approved control body at least ten working days before the dispatch.

6° – Vines under transitional measure:

At the latest on 1 January 2016, every operator concerned by the provisions set at XI (2°, a and b) must send to the defence and management body and to the control body the inventory of the parcels concerned.

II. – Keeping of registers

1° – Register of parcels whose trellised foliage height is between 0.6 times and 0.7 times the spacing between rows:

This register is kept available for the approved control body and a copy is attached annually to the claim declaration.

It indicates for each parcel concerned:

- the cadastral reference;

- the area;

- the year of planting;

- the variety;

- the spacings within the row and between rows.

2° – Particular documents:

Soil analysis before new planting, to be kept at least until the parcel concerned enters production for the AOC.

Record of maturity controls.

Record of vat analyses at the start, before alcoholic fermentation.

Cellar log containing the analyses before packaging: glucose and fructose, actual alcoholic strength (TAV), total SO2, volatile acidity (VA), malic acid (MA).

CHAPTER III

I – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A. – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1. – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area.	Documentary (using a geographic information system and the up-to-date CVI record) and in the field.
A2. – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of any derogatory measures, planting density and trellising, abandoned vines).	Checks carried out: documentary (based on the CVI grape-variety record and the geographic information system data); in the field.

A3. – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities. — Place of vinification.	Declarative and on site.
Minimum vinification capacity.	Documentary (inventory of containers).
Ageing (duration).	Documentary and on site.
Traceability of packaging.	Declarative (register keeping) and on site.
Justified storage place for packaged products.	Declarative and on site.
B. – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1. – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning.	Counting of the number of free eyes (buds) per stock and description of the pruning method.
Trellising rules and foliage height.	In the field.
Average maximum load per parcel.	In the field in the six weeks preceding the harvest. Counting of bunches and estimation of the load.
Cultivation condition of the vine.	Check at the parcel.
B2. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes.	Verification of the records (information sheet specifying the maturity-monitoring method and the sugar contents) at the operators'. By visual examination of the grapes.
B3. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment).	Documentary and on-site visit.
Monitoring of the dates relating to packaging.	Documentary and on-site visit.
B4. – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Missing vines.	Documentary (up-to-date list) and in the field.
Authorised yield.	Documentary (check of declarations, yield increase for certain operators [monitoring of the authorisations granted by the INAO services, after enquiry by the said services upon individual request of the operator]).
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield.	Documentary (monitoring of destruction certificates).
Claim declaration.	Documentary and on-site visit (compliance with the arrangements and deadlines, consistency with the harvest declaration). Control of the placing into circulation of the products.
C. – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines.	Analytical and organoleptic examination.
Packaged wines.	Analytical and organoleptic examination.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.

II – References concerning the control structure

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The INAO is the control authority ensuring compliance with the provisions of the present specification for the products benefiting from the controlled designation of origin.

ANNEX 1

LIST OF THE PARCELS EXCLUDED FROM THE DELIMITED AREA BENEFITING FROM A PRODUCTION TOLERANCE DEFINED IN CHAPTER I, PART XI-1. — TRANSITIONAL MEASURES RELATING TO THE DELIMITED PARCEL AREA

COMMUNE	SECTION	LOCALITY	No.	AREA (hectare)	VARIETY
Saint-Estèphe	A4	Canteloup	2170 (ex. 914)	0,0930	cabernet-sauvignon
Saint-Estèphe	A4	Canteloup	2170 (ex. 916)	0,0630	cabernet-sauvignon
Saint-Estèphe	A4	Canteloup	2170 (ex. 918)	0,0725	cabernet-sauvignon
Saint-Estèphe	B1	Lalande	1425p	0,2300	cabernet-sauvignon
Saint-Estèphe	ZP	Radet	34p	0,2150	merlot